

September is National Recovery Month.

Three simple ways to recognize it at your workplace. None of them cost anything, and all three can be done this month.

1 in 10

EMPLOYEES WITH
UNTREATED SUD

4 in 5

NEVER RECEIVE
TREATMENT

Most people never ask for help because asking feels like a risk. Recognizing Recovery Month is really about one thing — making it a little safer to speak up.

THREE WAYS TO RECOGNIZE IT

Rethink the drinks table

- Stock two or three genuinely good non-alcoholic options at your next company event.
- Same bar, same menu, same eye level as everything else.
- Have them offered first, not as a consolation.

Why it works: nobody has to opt out of anything, or explain why.

Make help easy to find

- Post the SAMHSA National Helpline: 1-800-662-HELP.
- Add findtreatment.gov and 988 for crisis.
- Put them on the intranet home page, the benefits portal, and the break room door.

Why it works: people can look without anyone knowing they looked.

Give managers one sentence

"I've noticed [something specific and work-related]. I'm not asking you to explain. I want you to know what's available, and that using it won't cost you your job."

- Describe behavior. Never diagnose.
- Don't promise confidentiality you can't deliver.

Why it works: most managers say nothing because no one ever gave them the words.

Sobriety is personal.

Total sobriety, recovery, sober curious, cutting back, or supporting someone you love — the work of a recovery-friendly workplace is making sure none of it has to be a secret.